

The Straight Answer Desk

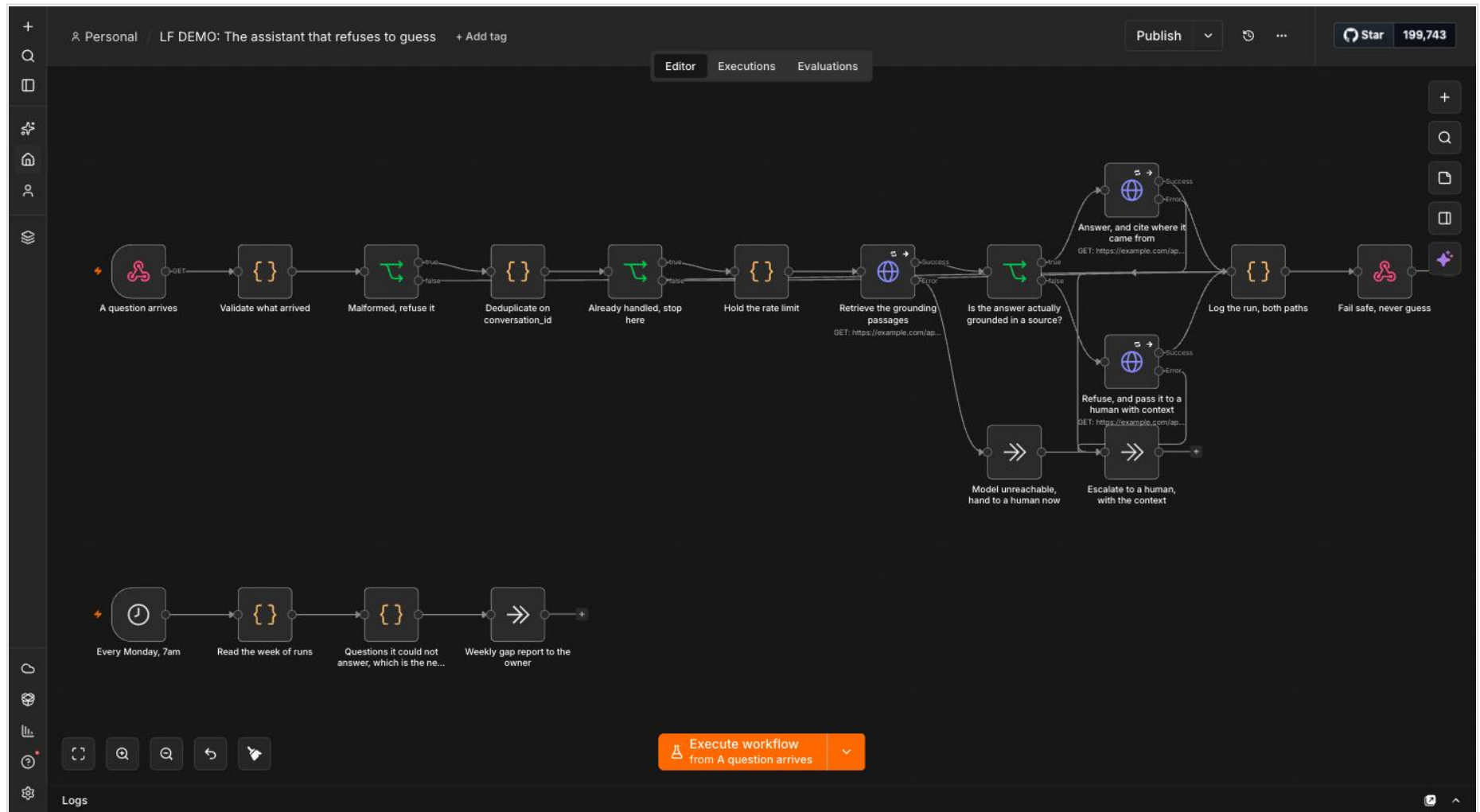
ai-assistant · built in n8n

An assistant that guesses is worse than no assistant, because people stop trusting the answers and go back to phoning you.

What it connects to: The model is not the product. The knowledge source it is grounded in, and the CRM it hands off to, are the product — and both live outside the model.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the assistant — it answers from a real knowledge base and refuses when it doesn't know.



The refusal gate is the product. It hands to a human with the context attached rather than inventing something.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a step titled "Is the answer actually grounded in a source?". The interface is divided into two main panels: "INPUT" on the left and "Parameters" on the right. The "INPUT" panel displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and a note "to view input data". The "Parameters" panel has tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings", with "Parameters" currently selected. It features an "Execute step" button in the top right corner. Under the "Conditions" section, there is a text input field containing a JSON expression: `{{ $json.grounded === true && $json.confidence > 0.75 }}`, followed by a dropdown menu set to "is true". Below this is a "+ Add condition" button. A toggle switch for "Convert types where required" is currently turned off, with a dropdown menu showing "Fixed" and "Expression". Under the "Options" section, there is a "+ Add option" button.

Is the answer actually grounded in a source?

INPUT

No input data

Execute previous nodes

to view input data

Parameters Settings

Execute step

Conditions

`{{ $json.grounded === true && $json.confidence > 0.75 }}` is true

+ Add condition

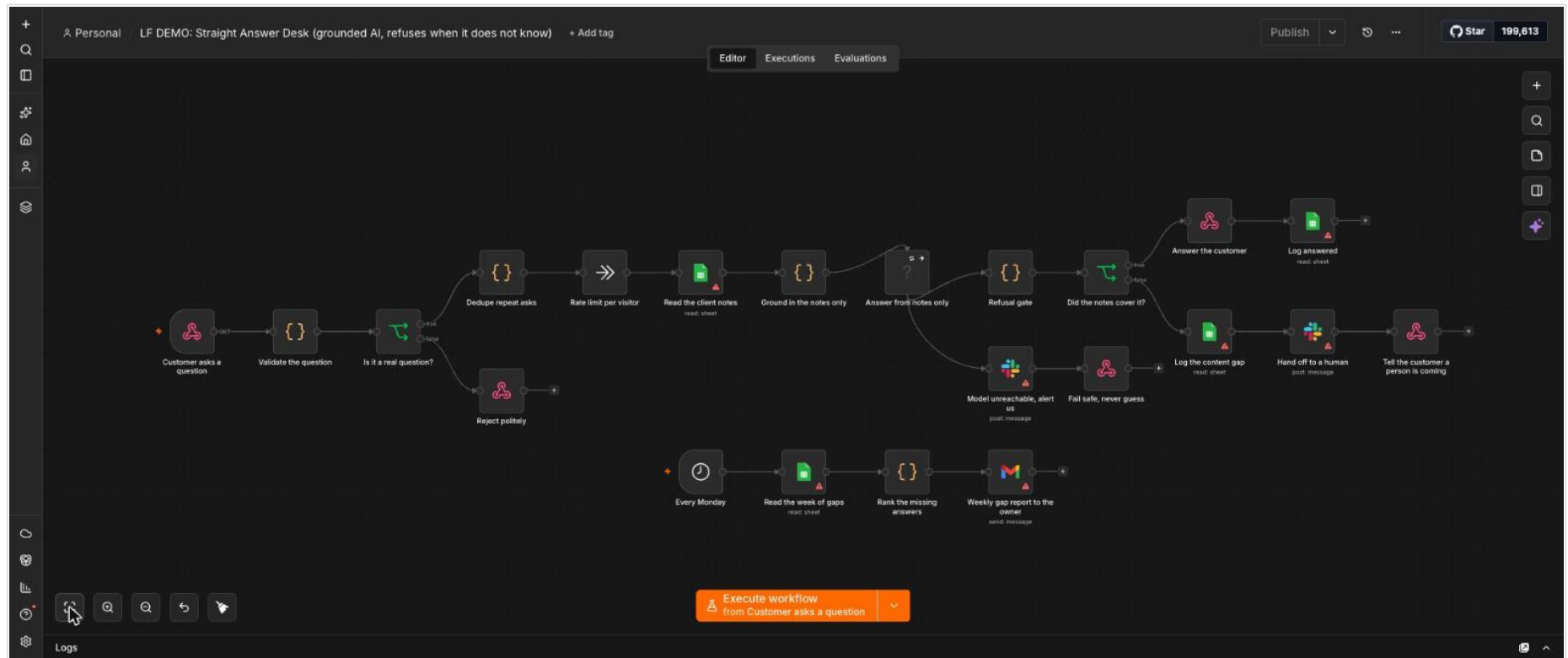
☐ Convert types where required Fixed Expression

Options

+ Add option

3 of 4 THEIR-WORLD

Running inside the tool, with the knowledge source it's actually trained on.



4 of 4 RESULT

And the behaviour settings — how long it waits, when it stops, when a person takes over.

